

1. Handbook Overview

Purpose, scope and document ownership

HARBORVIEW ANALYTICS LTD

KEY FACTS

EFFECTIVE DATE

1 April 2026

REVIEW CYCLE

Every 12 months

DOCUMENT OWNER

People Operations

POLICY MAILBOX

policy@harborview.example

POLICY DETAILS

This handbook sets out the operational rules used by Harborview Analytics Ltd. It applies to permanent employees, fixed-term employees and contractors who access company systems. Local employment contracts take priority where they provide a stronger entitlement.

Managers are responsible for explaining the rules to their teams. Employees should raise questions through the policy mailbox. Material changes are announced at least ten working days before they take effect, except where an urgent legal or security change is required.

OPERATING RULES

- The controlled copy is the version stored in the internal policy library.
- Printed and downloaded copies may become out of date.
- Policy exceptions require written approval from the relevant policy owner.
- Suspected policy conflicts should be reported before action is taken.

2. Working Arrangements

Hybrid attendance, core hours and flexible work

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KEY FACTS

OFFICE DAYS

Tuesday and Thursday

CORE HOURS

10:00-15:00 UK time

HOME-WORK LIMIT

3 days per week

REQUEST NOTICE

10 working days

POLICY DETAILS

Hybrid employees normally attend their assigned office on Tuesday and Thursday. Teams may agree a different pattern for client work, but employees must still attend at least two days each week unless a formal remote-work agreement is in place.

Working time may start between 07:30 and 10:00 and finish between 15:30 and 18:30. Everyone must be available during the core hours of 10:00 to 15:00 UK time. A standard working day includes a minimum 30-minute unpaid break.

OPERATING RULES

- Temporary changes should be agreed with the line manager in advance.
- Overseas remote work is limited to 20 working days in a calendar year.
- An overseas request must be submitted at least 10 working days before travel.
- Employees must use company-managed devices for all remote work.

3. Leave and Absence

Annual leave, carry-forward and sickness reporting

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KEY FACTS

ANNUAL LEAVE

28 paid days

CARRY-FORWARD

Up to 4 days

USE-BY DATE

28 February

SICKNESS NOTICE

By 09:30

POLICY DETAILS

Full-time employees receive 28 paid days of annual leave each holiday year, in addition to UK public holidays. Part-time entitlement is calculated on a pro-rata basis. The holiday year runs from 1 January to 31 December.

Up to four unused days may be carried into the next holiday year with manager approval. Carried-forward leave must be used by 28 February. Any remaining carried-forward balance expires after that date unless statutory leave rules apply.

OPERATING RULES

- Requests for five or more consecutive days require four weeks of notice.
- Managers should normally respond to a leave request within three working days.
- Sickness absence must be reported to the manager by 09:30 on the first day.
- A fit note is required when sickness lasts more than seven calendar days.

4. Business Expenses

Meal, hotel and receipt requirements

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KEY FACTS

DAILY MEALS

GBP 42

LONDON HOTEL

GBP 185 per night

OTHER UK HOTEL

GBP 135 per night

ITEMISED RECEIPT

Required above GBP 15

POLICY DETAILS

Reasonable expenses incurred wholly for business purposes may be reclaimed. The daily meal limit is GBP 42 when an employee is travelling away from their normal workplace for a full day. Alcohol is not reimbursable unless a director has approved a client event in advance.

The hotel limit is GBP 185 per night in London and GBP 135 per night elsewhere in the United Kingdom. These limits include taxes but exclude breakfast when breakfast is charged separately. An itemised receipt is required for any individual expense above GBP 15.

OPERATING RULES

- Expense claims must be submitted within 45 calendar days of the expense.
- Managers should approve or reject a claim within four working days.
- Personal loyalty points may be retained, but must not influence supplier choice.
- Cash tips are reimbursable up to 12.5 percent when shown on the receipt.

5. Business Travel

Booking, rail class, mileage and travel safety

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KEY FACTS

ADVANCE BOOKING

At least 14 days

RAIL CLASS

Standard class

MILEAGE - FIRST 10,000

45 pence per mile

MILEAGE - THEREAFTER

25 pence per mile

POLICY DETAILS

Travel should be booked through the approved travel portal. Domestic rail and air travel should be booked at least 14 days in advance where the schedule is known. Standard class is required for rail journeys under four hours.

Employees using a personal vehicle for approved business travel may claim 45 pence per mile for the first 10,000 business miles in a tax year and 25 pence per mile thereafter.

Commuting between home and the normal workplace is not business mileage.

OPERATING RULES

- International travel requires manager and cost-centre owner approval.
- A travel risk assessment is required for destinations rated high risk.
- Taxi use is allowed when public transport is unavailable or unsafe.
- Travel changes should be recorded in the booking portal within two days.

6. Information Security

Passwords, temporary access and security records

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KEY FACTS

PASSWORD LENGTH

At least 16 characters

TEMPORARY PRODUCTION ACCESS

Maximum 6 hours

AUTHENTICATION LOGS

Retained for 18 months

SCREEN LOCK

After 5 minutes

POLICY DETAILS

Multi-factor authentication is required for email, cloud services, source control and remote access. Passwords must contain at least 16 characters. Password sharing and reuse of company passwords on personal services are prohibited.

Temporary production access is limited to six hours and must be linked to an approved change or incident ticket. Authentication logs are retained for 18 months. Company devices automatically lock after five minutes of inactivity.

OPERATING RULES

- Lost devices must be reported to Security Operations within 30 minutes.
- Secrets must be stored in the approved secrets manager, not source code.
- Critical security patches must be installed within 72 hours.
- External storage devices are blocked unless a security exception is approved.

7. Data Protection and Retention

Retention periods and personal-data incidents

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KEY FACTS

JOB APPLICATIONS

Retained for 9 months

EXPENSE RECORDS

Retained for 7 years

SUPPORT TICKETS

Retained for 3 years

BREACH ESCALATION

Within 72 hours

POLICY DETAILS

Personal data must be collected for a defined business purpose and limited to what is necessary. Unsuccessful job applications are retained for nine months after the recruitment decision. Employee expense records are retained for seven years after the relevant financial year.

Customer support tickets are retained for three years after closure. A suspected personal-data breach must be reported immediately to the Privacy Team. The organisation assesses whether notification to the regulator is required within the 72-hour legal period.

OPERATING RULES

- Personal data must not be copied into unapproved collaboration tools.
- Access requests should be sent to privacy@harborview.example.
- Retention holds override normal deletion while an investigation is active.
- Data exports must be encrypted and transferred through approved channels.

8. Harborview Support API

Tokens, rate limits and idempotency controls

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KEY FACTS

ACCESS-TOKEN VALIDITY

45 minutes

STANDARD RATE LIMIT

240 requests/minute/client

IDEMPOTENCY RETENTION

36 hours

MAINTENANCE WINDOW

Sunday 02:00-04:00 UTC

POLICY DETAILS

OAuth access tokens issued for the Harborview Support API are valid for 45 minutes. The standard rate limit is 240 requests per minute per client. A 429 response includes a Retry-After header showing the number of seconds before another request should be attempted.

POST requests that create tickets must include an Idempotency-Key. The service retains each key and its result for 36 hours. Reusing the same key with a different request body returns a 409 conflict response.

OPERATING RULES

- API clients should use exponential backoff for 429 and temporary 5xx responses.
- The regular maintenance window is Sunday from 02:00 to 04:00 UTC.
- Webhook signatures use HMAC-SHA256 and should be checked before processing.
- API credentials must be rotated every 90 days.

9. Service Continuity

Availability, recovery objectives and backups

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AVAILABILITY TARGET

99.95 percent monthly

RECOVERY TIME OBJECTIVE

90 minutes

RECOVERY POINT OBJECTIVE

10 minutes

BACKUP RETENTION

35 days

POLICY DETAILS

The production service has a monthly availability target of 99.95 percent, excluding announced maintenance. The recovery time objective is 90 minutes. The recovery point objective is 10 minutes for ticket and customer-account data.

Encrypted backups are created daily and retained for 35 days. A restoration test is completed every quarter. The continuity plan is reviewed twice each year and after any priority-one incident that activates disaster recovery.

OPERATING RULES

- Production traffic can be moved to the secondary UK region.
- The incident commander decides when disaster recovery is activated.
- Service owners must keep recovery runbooks current and accessible offline.
- Quarterly restoration results are reported to the Risk Committee.

10. Incident Management

Priority levels, response times and communications

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KEY FACTS

P1 ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Within 15 minutes

P1 UPDATES

Every 30 minutes

POST-INCIDENT REVIEW

Within 5 working days

SECURITY HOTLINE

+44 20 7946 0188

POLICY DETAILS

A priority-one incident is a complete outage, confirmed data loss or critical security event affecting customers. The on-call engineer must acknowledge a P1 alert within 15 minutes. Stakeholder updates are issued every 30 minutes until service is stable.

A post-incident review must be completed within five working days. The review records the timeline, customer impact, contributing factors and assigned corrective actions. Corrective actions must have an owner and target date.

OPERATING RULES

- Security incidents should be reported through the 24-hour security hotline.
- P2 incidents require acknowledgement within one hour.
- Only the incident commander may declare an incident resolved.
- Customer communications must be approved by Support and Legal.